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Writing 2

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Writing Project 2

Critical Introduction

Annotating is a widely recognized teaching method by teachers that helps improve their student's reading comprehension. However, many students dread annotating and perceive it as a waste of time. My research question – How can teachers promote annotation to improve reading comprehension without sacrificing or hindering student's reading enjoyment? Is annotation helpful or detrimental to a student's learning experience in high school? – examines the benefits and drawbacks of annotating in high school education. Additionally, it explores whether reading enjoyment is an important aspect in education, and investigates ways educators can teach annotation effectively. Ultimately, teachers can achieve these benefits by encouraging students to enjoy reading, and exploring the many alternative annotation teaching methods that help mitigate its drawbacks.

The genre of my translation is a podcast, a conversation between authors about annotating. Podcasts are casual, informal conversations between friends or peers that fosters a casual, interactive environment between the host and the contributors. It encourages collaboration and building on ideas while allowing sources to disagree. Additionally, the “interview” format of the podcast integrates me in the conversation as I provide additional analysis, questions, and skepticism of the ideas from each source.

Most of my sources were lengthy journals written by teachers and one is a formal research study testing educational techniques. The audience of these were teachers and educators, and while this does not change in my translation, the podcast allows for these sources to communicate with each other and bring out information and ideas that are not in one place. Most articles focus on one aspect of annotations, like the benefits. In contrast, this translation will create a well rounded and informative discussion of easily digestible and accessible information for teachers.

Educators should be the primary audience of this research question and translation as they are responsible for refining literacy instruction in schools. They should understand and explore alternatives to teaching that will allow them to boost student's understanding and enjoyment of the text. While students may listen to the podcast, they do not have control over their assignments and how they are taught.

The podcast has five contributors: High School English teachers Matthew Brown, David Narter, Carol Porter-O'Donnell, English professor Johnny B. Allred at BYU, and a Mind, Brain, and Behavior researcher in Spain, Isabel Benítez. Each brings their unique teaching experience and research to help guide the listener to their conclusion on how to teach annotation in schools. Teachers will share their own students' opinions on annotation and their stances. Researcher Benítez will summarize her research results on how certain variables affected student literacy test scores. The conversation between these individuals encourages educators to see that teaching styles are fluid and lots of refinement is needed to amend how these tactics are used in schools. It additionally provides teachers with options for teaching annotation in school, including social annotation, that they can test in their classrooms. Rather than advocating for a specific viewpoint, educators can determine what is best for their students and classroom. At the end of the podcast, listeners choose whether annotating is necessary in high school classrooms, or if it should be abandoned or refined.

Teach it or Toss it: Episode 9: Annotations.

Introduction music plays.

Mila: Hello listeners, teachers and students, and welcome back to “Teach it or Ditch it” where I, your host Mila Matich, talk to teachers and researchers about certain reading, writing, and literacy teaching strategies in high school. Today, our topic is about annotations and we have several experts here to educate us on this reading comprehension strategy. As always, at the end of the podcast you as a listener can decide if we should...

Everyone: TEACH IT OR TOSS IT!

Cheering and applause sound effects play.

Mila: Today we have a wonderful group of guests ready to speak their minds and give us their two cents on annotations. They will talk about experiences in their classroom, and also some research that has been done regarding educational strategies! Maybe by the end of the day we will learn a new annotating technique... Why don't we have each one of you introduce yourselves.

Matthew D. Brown: I'll start! Hello everyone and my name is Matthew Brown, Mr. Brown for my students who may be listening today. I taught English for twelve years at Santa Clarita Christian School.

David Narter: Hey hey! I am David Narter and I taught English and AP Language and Composition at Leyden High School. I was there for about 19 years and I also am the author of two books and a handful of articles, go check them out!

Isabel Benítez: Hello everyone, pleasure to meet you all and to be here. My name is Isabel Benítez and I am an associate professor of Psychology at the Universidad Loyola Andalucía. I have my PhD in Psychology and have done my research on reading strategies for students through the Universities of Oviedo and Granada and the Mind, Brain, and Behavior Research Center in Spain. Excited to contribute to this conversation.

Carol Porter-O'Donnell: Wow we brought the big guns here! Excited to hear about your research Isabel. My name is Carol Porter-O'Donnell and I teach English at Deerfield High School in Illinois!

Johnny Allred: Hi everybody! My name is Johnny Allred and I am an assistant professor of English education at Brigham Young University. I worked together with high school English teacher Jami Reed. She was not able to make it together, but I will share our findings and opinions with you all.

Mila: Thank you all so much for being here today with me. Let's not waste any more time and let's jump right into it! Everyone has heard of annotating, marking up text and swinging that yellow highlighter all across your book assigned for school. Many of us may not be aware of the benefits. Could you guys weigh in on some of the “pros” of annotating?

Carol: Oh I would be more than happy to start this conversation. Annotating is something I do all the time. It is a powerful strategy in reading comprehension as it allows students to comprehend and engage with difficult material and facilitates active reading (Porter-O'Donnell 82). You know, I had some of my students reflect on annotations in preparation for this podcast. One of my students measured that “annotating [has] helped [them] see that reading is a process” (Porter-O'Donnell 85) and made them more active readers.

Matthew: I completely agree with you, Carol. Annotating a piece of text connects the reader to the story and what the author is trying to say. To me, understanding comes from interaction and connection with text (Brown 73). I encourage my students to make as many connections with the text as possible while annotating it to really connect with the story (Brown 74-75).

Carol: I totally agree! Some of my students even mention that annotating and making connections has allowed her students to understand things that they are not always interested in. In a sense, they are making it interesting (Porter O'Donnell 86).

David: You guys make some great points. I do agree that annotating is a useful tool in improving reading comprehension in certain genres, like trying to master the text, and scoring good on an English exam (Narter 66).

Mila: You seem to be biting your tongue, David, do you have anything else to add?

David: Well, I am not a big fan of annotating to be quite honest with you all. To go back to Matthews' comment on connecting with text, I find that to be distracting. Sometimes, personal connection is not always possible between the student and the text, so forcing this connection may shift the reader's attention away from the actual reading and make them hyper-fixate on a connection that just is not there (Narter 66). Not to be quite critical, but I did read your article.

Matthew: Well that is an interesting point, I would love to hear your feedback.

David: Well, you asked. One of your students appears to have written 91 words in annotation on 120-word text. She mentions that she connects with Gatsby from the book *The Great Gatsby* because she too has had an awkward encounter (Brown 75-76). But, well you know I shouldn't say.

Matthew: Please do, I am interested.

David: Okay, if you insist. "The idea that this 15-year old girl has anything in common with Gatsby and this particular example [you referenced] is ridiculous and only distracts us further from the literature" (Narter 66). If anything, the focus should be on the actual literature, not the connection a student has with it. It just slows down the reading process for no reason (Narter 66).

Matthew: Okay, noted. Thank you for the feedback.

Carol: If I could get into this action I actually have some students that appreciate the nature of slowing down the reading process. One of my students said that "annotating and written responses help me understand things now. This has slowed [her] reading down where [she thinks] about more things" (Porter- O'Donnell 86). Most of my students even appreciated that the reading process was slowed down (87).

Mila: Interesting! These are some great perspectives! I think we have covered a lot of the benefits of annotating, from reading comprehension and connection with texts. What could be some of the down sides? David I know you began to mention some, do you have anymore?

David: Boy do I! I just wanted to apologize to Matthew for attacking your article. I did find it very interesting and I agree to some extent that yes annotating is an important tool in education.

Matthew: Thank you, David. I truly appreciate your insight and I would love to hear what else you have to say.

David: I do think that annotating interrupts the reading process and the development of “good readers”, which is the language a lot of people tend to use in present academia when describing reading (Narter 65).

Mila: David, do you mind expanding on what a good reader is?

David: I wish I could, but we may not have time to deep dive into this. This may be a whole other podcast.

Chuckles in the room.

David: In reality, it is so hard to quantify what a good reader is due to the copious amounts of literature we have and the different types of reading that are needed in each situation. You really just cannot pin it down, if that makes sense (Narter 64-65).

Carol: You know ya that does make sense, you taught me something today David!

David: Hey thanks! Glad I could. But to expand on my point, annotating interferes with developing whatever a good reader may be. Humor me for a second. Are any of you aware of what Steve Sax Syndrome is?

Group looks confused

David: Alright well, Sax was an All-Star second baseman. When mastering a sport, your subconscious collects different methods that make you successful at the sport, like reading a pitch or timing your run to steal a base. When you think too hard about this process and break it down when it was originally just natural to you, you fall apart. You then “forget” how to do the tasks that were second nature to you (Narter 65).

Mila: Interesting! How would you connect this to annotating?

David: Well, when a student learns to read and reads all the time, they develop their methods that allow them to connect, analyze, and digest the text given to them. This makes reading “easy” and allows them to develop their methods of becoming a skilled reader. However, when you make them break it down, you interfere with their subconscious nature. Students then become hyper-focused on the new task, like annotating, which breaks apart all of the skills they have subconsciously built over the years of reading (Narter 65-66).

Carol: That is really interesting. As I mentioned before, I have had students who said that annotating really helped them understand the text and boosted their confidence and development of a skilled reader (Porter-O'Donnell 86-87).

Mila: Good point, are there any other downsides you can think of besides hindering what a good reader is?

David: Unfortunately, yes. And I hate to say it. My son has been an avid reader since the day he was born. Since starting high school, he says that reading has become more of a chore (Narter 63). This is called Readicide, coined by Kelly Gallagher who has written extensively on this subject. It's the notion that the joy behind reading has been killed through our education system (63). The basic line is, students hate annotating, it makes reading unenjoyable.

Carol: You know, I do have to agree with this. When I was asking students about annotating, one of my students did feel frustrated "by the amount of annotations required because they interrupt the flow of [his] reading" (Peter-O'Donnell 86), even though it boosted his understanding.

Matthew: Ya you know, some of my students straight up said that they "would rather cut grass with nail clippers" (Brown 73) than annotate.

Laughs around the room.

Mila: So there has been agreement that some students do dread annotating, which I think some students listening can agree with. When I was in high school, I definitely dreaded annotating, it was a hassle, but I did get a lot of benefits from it. Does enjoyment of reading really matter in the context of school?

Carol: In my opinion, if this is answering the question correctly, I think that there should be a separation between reading for fun and reading for school (Porter-O'Donnell), learning and enjoyment are two separate entities. So I personally do not think it matters.

David: I hate to be the "Negative Nelly" here but I disagree. There should be no separation, in fact the more students enjoy reading, the higher they score on standardized tests! Some researchers I read found "a high correlation between independent reading time and reading achievement scores, vocabulary acquisition, writing style, spelling, and grammatical development" (Narter 67).

Isabel: I believe one of those researchers is me!

David: Is that so?!

Isabel: Yes and I would love to share with all of you. I won't get into all the nitty gritty statistical stuff but you can read all about my methods and procedure if you guys want some more of it in my research paper "Strategies for Promoting Reading Competence: Teaching Practices and Enjoyment of Reading".

Mila: I love all of the plugs we are getting in this session. It's awesome! Tell us about your study Isabel.

Isabel: In summary, I used statistical data and models to test the effects of certain educational variables on test scores. These test scores were taken cross linked with students reading enjoyment levels and other reading strategies and variables. I found that reading literacy was most strongly impacted by the enjoyment of reading, more than the effect of summarizing text and annotation-like techniques, which was ranked second (Benítez 347).

Mila: You know, that actually makes sense. The more students want to read and enjoy it, the better they are going to retain the information. That goes back to what you were saying earlier David. The more they read on their own and enjoy it, it seems like I can conclude that they can develop more of those self-conscious reading techniques!

Isabel: You know, ya! That sounds about right. The students who saw reading less as a waste of time performed better on our test than those who practiced metacognitive summarizing, read online frequently, and had a good memory (Benítez 345).

Mila: This is awesome! Thanks for sharing with everybody! So I think we've reached a point where we have some background knowledge on the pros and cons of annotating, and also reasons why reading enjoyment is important. What are some ways annotating should be taught and how do you go about teaching them?

Carol: I can start off this conversation! Before reading, I give my students an example guide and symbols that can be used in the margins of a story to mark up the text. After students annotate, the class gets together to discuss what they have marked and why (Porter-O'Donnell 83).

Matthew: How cool! I also use discussion as a useful tool for reading comprehension in addition to annotations. To introduce annotations to my class, I have them come up with ideas that make annotations good and effective annotations. That way, I am not forcing a particular style onto them that may not work for them (Brown 74).

Carol: That's awesome! Collaboration with peers also allows my students to find a way that works best for them to annotate and make sense of whatever they are reading (Porter-O'Donnell 83-85).

David: Just a quick question, how do you think having students annotate affects their reading pattern? I know we mentioned before that students liked the process of slowing down reading, what about for students who don't?

Mila: You stole my question, David!

Carol: You make a good point. My student Daniel had that exact concern, the one who found annotating beneficial but frustrating. Well, to address this concern that was popular amongst students, we advised another annotating tactic. "We decided that marking important quotations or passages with an asterisk while reading would help with the problem of interrupting the flow. These students would then go back into the text to reflect on the importance of the passage and record their thoughts in the margins of the text and/or write about these important passages in their journals or use some other writing-to-learn strategy" (Porter-O'Donnell 86).

David: What a nice idea!

Matthew: I may have to use that in my classrooms Carol! I could use that in my in class discussions after students annotated to share what they marked with others and how they connected with the text. It's a great way to bring together annotating and collaboration amongst peers (Brown 76).

Johnny: Finally! Something I can be of use for. In my study and Jami's classrooms, we used social annotations. Unlike the traditional pen-to-paper annotation technique, social annotations are "a digital tool that allows readers to share their thoughts with others outside of their physical setting and even around the world, making the reading experience more connective across readers and texts, space and time" (Allred 66). It allows students to reply to each other's annotations, and facilitate conversations online while reading. These were informal assessments that were not based on the number of annotations just completed. Jami saw that understanding and comprehension of the text increased as students continued to interact with one another (Allred 67).

Mila: How cool is that I have never heard of social annotations. It helps engage students in conversation even when they are not in person!

Johnny: Ya! It also allows us as teachers to elevate student voices who are too shy to participate in the in class discussions of the text (Allred 72). It's really just a win on everyone's behalf.

Mila: What do students think of this new tool? Do they enjoy it?

Johnny: Well (*awkward silence*). I didn't think to ask them to be honest.

Isabel: If I may jump in, I think it would be beneficial to ask students their opinions on the new tactic to see if they enjoy it. From my study, I found that reading development and teaching methods truly go hand in hand. The way you teach affects their ability to learn (Benítez 348).

David: I agree with you! Preach!

Isabel: Thanks for the support! Using polling tactics in my study I did find that supportive and engaging teaching strategies where educators provided additional support and help to students was the only major teaching tactic that significantly affected the literacy test scores. That being said, and as concluded in the study, teaching effective reading strategies and encouraging reading enjoyment should be a priority for educators (Benítez 348). So it may be a good idea to check in with your students to see if they enjoy it, and that goes for everybody.

Johnny: Will do! Thanks for the advice.

Carol: You know I did ask some of my students, and while some of their enjoyment increased because they understood it more, others said their enjoyment did not change. Does anyone have any suggestions on how to improve reading enjoyment in my class (Porter-O'Donnell 87-88)? I am really looking to boost my test scores!

David: I do! So actually I did not mention this early but one of my biggest issues with annotating is that it is a method that quantifies reading as a grade, which inevitably puts the "gradebook" and standardized testing at the forefront of the student learning experience (Narter 64).

Mila: Wow, I have never thought about it that way, but it does make sense when reading is assigned. I hated when I got graded for my annotations. It made me not want to read.

David: Exactly! That is exactly how my son feels. To answer the prior question, I did find a study that shares that silent reading encourages reading, and allows for students to build up their own reading comprehension tactics, skills, and confidence on their own. This way, instead of forcing annotations and disrupting a hobby that people love, silent reading encourages reading as a fun pastime without being disturbed or distracted (Narter 66).

Matthew: You know, that makes a great point.

Mila: Ya, honestly maybe we can make a little mix of both so students can still enjoy reading what they love, and still have the option to use annotation techniques that all of you mentioned.

David: Great points! And although standardized testing and producing students with good test scores many never leave our education system ...

Mila: Which it should! In my opinion!
Chuckles all around.

David: Haha! It is important to create life-long readers to maintain good readers, and not destroy the enjoyment of reading for just a short-term goal (Narter 67).

Isabel: And even if you really care about those test scores, the more your students enjoy reading, the better they are going to do anyway! The effect of enjoying reading and annotating produces very similar test scores, with students who enjoy reading a little higher than those who annotate. So, you might as well teach your students how to like reading (Benítez 347-348)!

David: And not kill the fun while you're at it!

Mila: Amazing conversation guys! I think this is a good point to end our podcast, but I would like to thank all of you for coming in with all of your knowledge and opinions.

Johnny: Thanks for having us!
Collective thanks.

Mila: Of course! And as always, after hearing all of this about annotating, our pros and cons, concerns, the importance of reading enjoyment in high school, and a new method of teaching through social annotation, do we ...

Everyone: TEACH IT OR TOSS IT!
Outro music and laughter.

Annotated Bibliography

Allred, Johnny B., et al. "Asking Questions and Speculating about Texts: Socially Annotating Shakespeare." *English Journal, High school edition*, vol. 113, no. 2, 2023, pp. 66–73, <https://doi.org/10.58680/ej202332737>. Johnny B. Allred, an assistant professor of English education at Brigham Young University, Jami Reed, a high school English teacher, and Christian Z. Goerin, a past chair of English Language Arts Teacher Educators, examines the effects of employing social annotation in a school setting in replacement to individual annotations, which can be isolating. While assigning these readings, Jami and Chris did not provide a specific amount of annotations required, however, encouraged students to reply and build upon each other's notes. It was found that these methods increased activity in those whose voices were not heard a lot in class, facilitated deep discussion, and provided the teacher with clarity on where to reteach things that were misinterpreted. Students were also thinking outside of the text, began to change the way they annotated to not rewrite what was already said in the text, and expanded on ideas with peers, which resulted in higher-level thinking.

This study is relevant to my research project as it provides an alternative to traditional annotating, allowing for group collaboration with text, and shifting away from the typical way of reading to be a collaborative one. It would be interesting if the author included student reactions to the text, as reading and education should be focused on the students and their opinions, and not so much on how the teacher feels, so that would be a good area for expansion in this article. It was noted that the annotations were time-consuming, however it is unclear if the students preferred this way of reading or the other.

Benítez, Isabel, et al. “Strategies for Promoting Reading Competence: Teaching Practices and Enjoyment of Reading.” *Psicothema*, vol. 35, no. 4, 2023, pp. 340–50,

<https://doi.org/10.7334/psicothema2022.509>. Elena Govorova, Isabel Benítez, and

Marcelino Cuesta through the Universities of Oviedo and Granada and the Mind, Brain,

and Behavior Research Center in Spain were interested in evaluating how educational

strategies and various variables influence the development of reading. The study begins

by outlining prior research and explaining the importance of literacy and how factors that

prompt reading development and factors within the education system go hand in hand.

The authors analyze other studies, however, they cannot be extrapolated to the

international level, whereas the study they are conducting can. The authors identify and

analyze the important variables that influence reading development using a Differences in

Differences model, along with several statistical strategies that have been employed in

similar research studies, attributing the validity of the research. The method of study was

to facilitate a cognitive test for students and compare their performance in reading to their

scores in mathematics, which served as the control. The difference in test scores between

reading and math determined their success in literacy, which is questionable but makes

sense when learning the treatment variables. Scores were crossed link with treatment

variables, which included enjoyment of reading, reading strategies (such as summarizing

and annotating), and teaching strategies employed by the teachers. The study found that

supportive and engaging teaching strategies where educators provided additional support

and help to students showed an increase in reading test results. Additionally, reading

literacy was strongly impacted by the enjoyment of reading and the skill set of

summarizing texts, as in students who reported they scored better than others. The study agreed with other studies in regards to the enjoyment and achievement rates being positively correlated.

This study is useful in my project as it shares that increasing enjoyment of reading through teaching can boost test scores in the same way that summarizing and annotating text can. Both are just as important in reading literacy. Thus, as the study concludes, and other sources agree, teaching effective reading strategies and encouraging reading enjoyment should be the priority for educators. The source is misleading as I expected there to be specific teaching tactics applied, however it was just students reporting what they used and understood. It would be a stronger study if the educational tactics were employed in cohorts and then test scores and comprehension were studied, then there would be a significant difference.

Brown, Matthew D. “I’ll Have Mine Annotated, Please: Helping Students Make Connections with Texts.” English Journal, High school edition, vol. 96, no. 4, 2007, pp. 73–78, <https://doi.org/10.2307/30047169>. Veteran English teacher Matthew D. Brown at Santa Clarita Christian School shares how he attempts to increase reading amongst students by spreading the importance of connecting with text by annotating. He shares his connection to Dr. Valeria Wayne, who vigorously annotated text to interact with the content. Brown suggests that reading should be centered around the personal connection and conversations we have with text to grasp the value of reading. Brown argues that understanding and comprehension come from interaction and connection

through annotations. I agree with this idea, however, it is not always someone who can directly relate to the text, rather they read it for pure enjoyment. This disagrees with David Narter's idea as he believes personal connection is not always possible and this always takes away from actually reading.

To promote his ideas, Brown tasks his students to annotate a passage that most resonates with them, giving them options on what to read, which is better than forcing a singular passage. He assigns an annotation guide, encouraging students to make as many connections as possible. He promotes variety in annotation, which is appreciated, however, forces the page to be full of notes, a timely and tedious task. Wouldn't this process take away from enjoying the book, and make it even more of a task that needs to be completed? The article supports the idea of annotation to promote reading engagement and get students to connect with and enjoy reading by making meaningful connections. However, this can be done by sharing the ideas, and not forcing a connection with text when there may not be any at all, especially when books are assigned in high school. I do agree with the post-annotation process of holding discussions, however creating web pages and detailed annotations takes away from the story of the book, and centralizes it around the reader, taking away from the message. The text already mentions that the students dislike annotations, so assigning heavy annotations is counterintuitive.

Narter, David. "Pencils Down: Is Mimicking the Behaviors of 'Good Readers' Bad for Good Readers?" *English Journal*, High school edition, vol. 102, no. 5, 2013, pp. 63–68, <https://doi.org/10.58680/ej201323589>. Author and High School teacher David

Narter attacks the notion of annotating as a tool that seems to counterintuitively disrupt the reading of young scholars. Narter begins by establishing the basis of annotation as a required tool for reading comprehension that is merely necessary for the classroom grade books. Annotating, according to scholars he references, is needed to improve standardized test scores and metacognitive thinking, however, it is mostly a way for teachers to turn reading into a graded assignment. He critiques this mode of education by putting standardized testing and grading at the forefront of education as counterintuitive to creating what teachers claim to be “good readers”. Narter questions the concept of what a “good reader” actually is, as it is subjective to the subject matter and purpose of the reading, and is hard to quantify. He then argues that assigning annotation hinders the development of whatever a “good reader” is as it interferes with the natural process of reading and comprehension, a key focus of my research. Narter references “Steve Sax Syndrome”, where when you become hyper-aware of what you are doing, you effectively decrease your success and the task you are trying to do, making it harder. Annotating does this, interfering with how good readers know how to read and shifts the focus of reading elsewhere rather than the actual focus of the literature. Along with that, annotation kills the joy behind reading, which he references as “readicide”.

The focus of my research lies around how to teach reading and annotating in a fun way. Studies referenced in this article show that silent reading encourages reading among students, which builds up their comprehension tactics and skills. When students enjoy reading, they perform better on standardized tests. Instead of forcing annotations, disrupting students’ enjoyment of reading, and focusing on gradebook/standardized

learning, schools should encourage reading as a fun pastime. The author points out the benefits of annotating in certain genres, however instead of inflicting these, they can be recommended practices, allowing students to find a way to read that works best for them. The article points out that making reading fun can mimic the “beneficial outcomes” of annotating. Narter, as a credible source of a teacher, ends the article by explaining that the purpose of teaching reading is to create lifelong readers and encourage them to continue reading, and not steer them away from what they love.

Porter-O'Donnell, Carol. “Beyond the Yellow Highlighter: Teaching Annotation Skills to Improve Reading Comprehension.” *English Journal*, High school edition, vol. 93, no. 5, 2004, pp. 82–89, <https://doi.org/10.2307/4128941>. Carol Porter-O'Donnell, a High School English teacher in Deerfield Illinois, argues that annotating promotes active reading and enhances reading comprehension. Her students were provided with a guide on how to annotate and practiced as a class to demonstrate that annotating can come in different forms, which is an effective mode of teaching annotation. Through peer collaboration, students were able to find what mode works best for them, which they could apply to their reading. This is a helpful tactic that allows students to make their own decisions while annotating, a great tactic employed by the author and useful in my research. Porter-O'Donnell also suggests alternative ways to “slow down” reading by reading aloud or taking side notes. She also suggests that there is a difference between reading for enjoyment and learning, whereas the David Narter article argues there should be no separation, and this idea contradicts the research question that promotes making annotating enjoyable.

Regardless, the author shares benefits students obtained from annotating, one whose enjoyment did not change, another who noted that slowing down the process allowed for deeper connection, and another who mentioned that annotations interrupt the flow of reading, a concern mentioned in David Narter's article. However, Porter-O'Donnell provides an alternative way to annotate while not disrupting flow by marking extant to return to at a later time to analyze. Although annoying, students appreciated annotating as it helped them learn and understand more, which some students noted made reading more enjoyable, which is beneficial to my study that annotations should not be exterminated as a practice, just slightly edited. The author mentions ways to employ annotations without interrupting reading, and evidence that enhanced reading comprehension can promote the enjoyment of reading, encourage students to have fun, and teach them that the process can work for them. An idea is to not make this practice required, however, I agree with the introduction and peer collaboration method that shows students how and allows them to decide if they want to do it on their own.